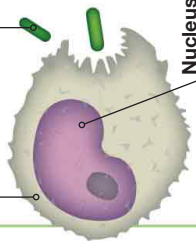


Germ eater

If germs do enter the tissues, the immune system defends the body. White blood cells, such as macrophages, track down invading germs, especially bacteria. Having identified germs as foreign, these cells surround and destroy them.

Macrophage

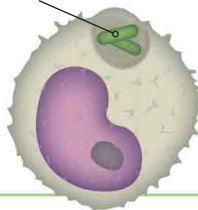
Bacterium



A **macrophage** tracks down bacteria, surrounds them, and takes them into its cell.

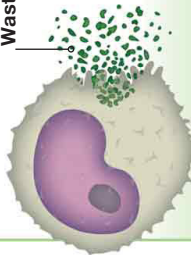
Nucleus

Bacteria digested

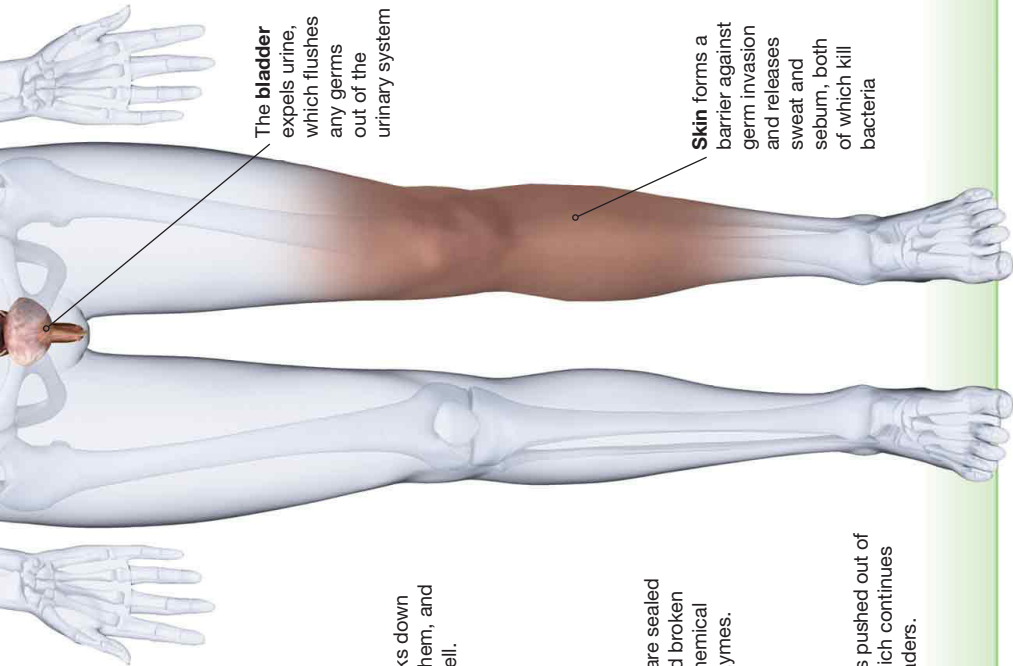


Captured bacteria are sealed off inside the cell and broken down by powerful chemical digesters, called enzymes.

Waste expelled



Undigested waste is pushed out of the macrophage, which continues to hunt for more invaders.



The **bladder** expels urine, which flushes any germs out of the urinary system

Skin forms a barrier against germ invasion and releases sweat and sebum, both of which kill bacteria